master of orthodoxy. God be praised!' And finally, about the rumours that may have reached Turan, Akbar pointed out that 'neither God nor Prophet has escaped the slanders of men, much less I'. Abdullah Khan Uzbek died in 1598, effectively bringing to an end the Uzbek menace.

In the decade from 1587 to 1597, Akbar would move first to one end of the empire, then to the other, in both cases extending the frontiers of Mughal rule further than they had ever been before. Kashmir, Kandahar, and the Hindu Kush, were brought firmly within his dominions. Much more resistant to the Padshah's will, however, would be his own sons, grown into men, with ambitions of their own. To keep them safe from each other, Akbar would separate his sons and his amirs by sending them away from court, into the different corners of the empire, but despite all the Padshah's efforts, most would not return alive.

---

*Though there are records of a couple more marriages to daughters of minor chieftains.